

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 6 2
♥ Q 10 7 6
♦ 6 4
♣ 9 6 3

♠ K 8 5

♥ A 2

♦ A 7 3

♣ A K Q 7 2



♠ J 7 4 3

♥ K J 9 5

♦ Q 9 5

♣ 8 5

♠ Q 9

♥ 8 4 3

♦ K J 10 8 2

♣ J 10 4

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Even if you wanted to show your ♦ suit how would you do it? If you bid 3♦ it would be a transfer and if you bid 4♦ you would have bypassed 3NT, your probable best contract.

But you didn't want to bid them anyway, you just wanted to bid 3NT, right?

The contract would be 3NT played by South.

East leads ♥5, West plays the ♥Q.

The first thing you need to decide is whether to hold up on the ♥.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 8

First decide the holdup question. East led the ♥5 and you can see the ♥4, ♥3 and ♥2. Assuming East led fourth down he must have only a 4-card suit since there are no cards he could have lower than the ♥5. With ♥s splitting 4-4 a holdup would do no good, and isn't necessary anyway.

So take the ♥A. Then what?

You COULD try the ♦ finesse. Even if it loses it would establish several ♦ winners. However, if the defenders win just 1 ♦ trick they will quickly grab their 3 ♥ tricks and their ♠A and put you down 1.

This is why it is important to You need just one additional winner and all you have to do to get it is play a ♠ honor.

When you can see all four hands, including the location of the ♦Q, it kind of makes you wished you had finessed and gotten all those overtricks.

Good Bridge players like to take tricks, but they are not greedy.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 8 5 3
♥ A J 4 2
♦ 5
♣ A 6 4

♠ 9 6

♥ Q 10 8 3

♦ J 9 6 2

♣ Q J 3

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W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 10 2
♥ K 7
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 7 5

♠ 7 4

♥ 9 6 5

♦ A 10 8 4

♣ 10 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			
6♠ by East			

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

Since the ♦ loser is a sure thing you will need to find somewhere to discard a ♣. There are three possibilities: Finesse South for the ♥Q. (50% chance) Try to drop the ♥Q by ruffing the third round. (also about 50%) Establish a ♦ honor. (100% certain)

First pull trumps, ending in dummy. It takes two rounds. Next play the ♦5 toward your ♦Q. South wins this and plays another ♣. Win the ♣, come to your hand with the ♥K, then play your good ♦Q, discarding dummy's losing ♣.

You will need to ruff two ♥s in your hand, but the rest of the tricks are yours.

This was pretty easy because the trumps split 2-2.

If they had been 3-1 you would have had to leave the last trump undrawn until after you had ruffed two ♥s in your hand.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; he expects you to bid 2♠. However, with such great ♠ support and an outside doubleton your hand now revalues to 18 points - more than an opening 1NT. You indicate this with a jump to 3♠. This is called a "Super-Accept". Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

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Blackwood, and with one Ace you answer 5♦. Partner bids 6♠ and everybody passes.

Obviously you aren't going to hold up on the ♣ lead. It won't matter where you take it, but assume you win in your hand.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5 3

♥ 6

♦ K Q J 9

♣ A 7 5 3

♠ A J 6

♥ Q J 9 7 5 2

♦ 6 4 2

♣ 8



♠ 10 9 7 2

♥ A 8

♦ 10 8 3

♣ 10 9 6 4

♠ K 4

♥ K 10 4 3

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q J 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

With 10 points and a 6-card ♥ suit you want to transfer. You say 2♦ and partner bids 2♥.

With 10 points and a 6-card ♥ suit you want to transfer. You say 2♦ and partner bids 2♥.

You know you want to play in ♥s since partner will have at least 2 of them. Your problem is whether to merely invite with 3♥ or go ahead and bid the game. Since partner has either 15, 16 or 17 points you should probably just bid 4♥. The worst thing that could happen is that partner would be playing game with only 25 points.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦K. Do you hold up or not?

There is no reason to hold up. Besides, you have bigger problems to deal with.

After you take the ♦A at trick one you have four fast losers staring you in the face the instant you lose the lead. So do you pull trumps now?

No, you dare not touch trumps yet - remember those 4 fast losers.

You cannot avoid the ♥A and ♣A, so you must get rid of one of the ♦ losers before you play trumps.

Win the ♦A, play the ♠K, then finesse the ♠J. If the finesse works discard a ♦ on the ♠A, then pull trumps. If the finesse fails you will go down 2 instead of 1.

You made it - on a 50% chance.

When the cards MUST lie in a particular way for the contract to be makeable, just assume that's the way they lie and go for it.